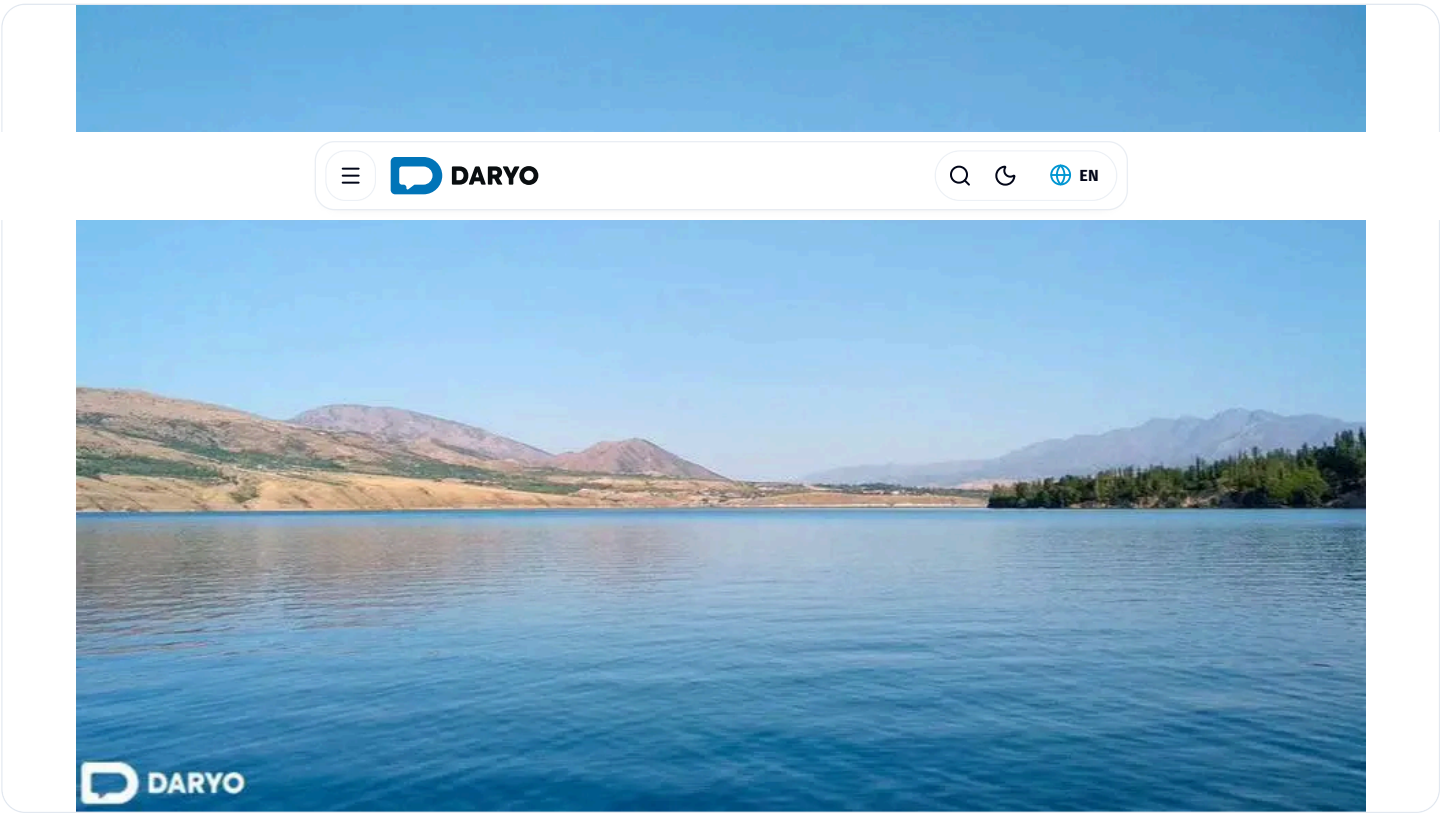
UZBEKISTAN

Uzbekistan targets 100% water-saving coverage on cultivated land

Uzbekistan plans to extend water-saving technologies to all cultivated land within five years, while expanding green areas and strengthening environmental protection as part of a national program focused on water and natural resource management.

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Uzbekistan plans to expand water-saving technologies to cover all cultivated land within the next five years as part of a national program focused on water conservation, environmental protection and increasing green areas.

The plans were discussed at an event organized by the Committees on Agrarian and Water Management and Ecology and Environmental Protection of the Legislative Chamber of the Oliy Majlis. Participants included members of the committees' public councils, representatives of scientific and research institutions and employees of analytical centers.

The meeting focused on the fourth of seven national programs outlined by President Shavkat Mirziyoyev during his speech marking the 35th anniversary of Uzbekistan's independence. The program calls for changes in the country's approach to water resources and environmental management.

Participants noted that climate change and population growth are increasing demand for water resources while creating additional requirements for environmental protection and the expansion of green areas. Measures discussed included wider use of water-saving technologies, more efficient management of land and water resources, scientific and technological approaches and measures to improve environmental practices.

Deputy Muqaddas Ahmedova said the fourth national program sets a nationwide target of bringing coverage of water-saving technologies on cultivated land to 100% within the next five years. The program also provides for further development of the nationwide "Green Space" initiative. Green areas surrounding schools, kindergartens, hospitals and apartment buildings are expected to receive additional protection.

Another target is to increase the share of green areas in district and city centers to 30% in the coming years. According to participants, the fourth national program combines several areas of environmental policy, including conservation of water resources, wider adoption of resource-saving agricultural technologies, improvement of environmental conditions and expansion of green spaces.

The program is one of seven initiatives outlined for Uzbekistan's next stage of development. Other programs cover education and skills, public health and longevity, transition toward a high-technology and higher-productivity economic model, judicial independence, the role of mahallas in social development and Uzbekistan's international positioning.

During the meeting, lawmakers and experts also discussed mechanisms for implementing the water and environmental targets. Participants agreed on the need to strengthen cooperation between parliamentary committees and their public councils and to involve specialists in addressing sector-specific issues.

The committees and the Public Council plan to prepare a joint work plan and work on improving scientific, legal and practical mechanisms for implementing the objectives of the fourth national program.

#independence #mechanisms #objectives #program #scientific #work



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